Sunday, 8 February 2026 — The Three פרשיות, הודו, and שיר השירים

Independent review · read fresh, from the finished HTML only (as delivered, before part-3 corrections) · 8 November 2026

1.Overall Read

An eleven-section write-up with a short closing summary (roughly 4,600 words of body plus a twenty-three-note *Mareh Mekomos* apparatus) of a Sunday-morning shiur that closes weekday *Shacharis* with three short *parshiyos*, opens the Shabbos prayers with *Hodu*, and then turns to *Shir HaShirim*. The arc is clear and it is an easy read: the opening *hesped* sets a tone that the close returns to; the three *parshiyos* are neatly parallel; the *Hodu* section is a well-told story; and the second half, built on the single number 117, is the strongest writing in the piece. The hard editorial issues are six: (a) Section III attributes a "*minhag* in Jerusalem" and a "*takanah*" to a Spanish author, and it is not clear where the idea comes from; (b) the *Seder HaYom* sentence in Section IV does not set up the question that follows it; (c) the Rokeach is born "at the end of the seventeenth century" in the body and "c. 1665" in fn 21; (d) the account of the rats in Section VIII and fn 15 do not agree; (e) a garbled, nested title in Section IX ("שו״ת יעריות שלמה in שו״ת יונת אלם"); and (f) an internal working note left in fn 5 ("file 50, fn 1; file 51").

2.What Works

- **The opening.** The *hesped* says what it needs in a few short paragraphs, and the sentence "What endures when הקדוש ברוך הוא separates the נשמה from the גוף? Only the מצוות, the תורה, and the חסד" is exactly right.
- **The Chacham Tzvi and his *tefillin* (III).** A good short story with a

point: the minute and a half, the son watching, "*Abba, what are you saying?*" It earns its place as the reason the passage migrated into the siddur.

- **The theological question (IV).** "What does it mean to ask for יראת שמים when everything but it is in Heaven's hands?" is posed cleanly, and the answer, however briefly, is memorable ("He has no choice, כביכול").
- **The reason for the daily recital (V).** The *hamarbeh lo he'diph* paragraph and its caution against too much *hishtadlus* is the most useful practical passage in the piece; the Gra's twist, and the answer to it, are neatly done.
- **The *Hodu* story (VII).** The Besht's plan, the storm, the arrival on *Erev Shabbos*, the realization of מניעות and the institution of the custom are well paced; the admission that these are legends keeps the story in its place.
- **The arithmetic (X–XI).** The 144 − 27 = 117 and 3 × 39 = 117 are set out so that a reader can check them; the callout for the latecomer is a pleasant touch.
- **Footnote hygiene.** Twenty-three notes in body order with matching back-links; the Hebrew-inline convention is consistent.

3.Where It's Weak or Could Be Sharper

Section III: "a מנהג ירושלים" and "a תקנה" Rabbeinu Yonah (fn 2: Gerona, c. 1180–1263) is said to note a *minhag* of Jerusalem to recite the passage daily, which then "became a *takanah*." Nothing says why a Spanish author would speak of a Jerusalem custom, whose *takanah* it was, or how a custom becomes one; fn 2 repeats it as "the מנהג ירושלים of his era." This needs a source or should be cut. As written it reads like a slip.

Section IV: the *Seder HaYom* sentence and the question that follows. The text says R' Moshe ben Machir writes that reciting *Parshas HaTeshuvah*

with *kavanah* "strengthens his resolve for תשובה through the entire year," and the next subsection then begins: "An important question: how can a yid be מחוין that all the מעשים של ישראל should do תשובה?" The word *mechaven* and the *resha'im* have not been introduced; the reader has to guess that the previous sentence was meant to say it. Fn 4 also says the daily recital "was instituted by R' Moshe ben Machir and others," which the body does not say.

Section V: ץ"תשב and the Maharam's students. The body says *Tashbetz* is an acronym for תלמיד שמשון בר צדוק. A reader who knows the genre will hesitate: the letters *tav-shin-bet-tzadi* read naturally as *Teshuvos Shimshon bar Tzadok*, and the later *Tashbetz* that fn 10 mentions is likewise a responsa title. Second, the Maharam (d. 1293) is said to have been the *rebbe* of "the אגודה," but the *Agudah* is the work of R' Alexander Suslin HaKohen, who lived long after the Maharam, so it cannot be a student's work in this sense. (The *Hagahos Maimoniyos* would fit.)

Section V: "ישראל מי שתמצ struggled." The sentence sets up why the passage moved to the end of the siddur, and it is vague. The point is that someone objected to praying for *parnassah* before davening; say who, or say "it was objected."

Section VIII: *Rishonim* and the *Arizal*. "The ראשונים write that the only time a yid can become a vessel… is just before שבת." The גוה is ancient — it comes from the אריז"ל and his תלמידים. The Ari is sixteenth-century, hardly a *Rishon* and hardly "ancient"; and fn 18 attributes the point to the *Shaar HaKavanos*. Choose one, or say that the lecturer says *Rishonim*.

Section VIII and fn 15: the rats and the decree. The body says the Gemara explains that scrolls were stored beside the *terumah*, rats came for the *terumah* and damaged the scrolls, so the Sages decreed that hands become *tamei*. Fn 15 quotes the Gemara (in Hebrew, with an ellipsis) as saying that the Sages enacted that books "disqualify the *terumah*" ("פוסלין את התרומה"), and nothing in the quotation mentions mice. The decree is stated two ways (hands that touch; books that disqualify) and the rats are unquoted. Either they are the lecturer's gloss or the Gemara's; say which.

Section IX: "The שו״ת יערות שלמה / שו״ת יונת אלם שלי׳. Two titles nested in each other, neither one a name a reader will recognize; and the point is a remark about being "photographed" by an eighteenth-century author, which cannot be what is meant. It looks like a transcription error and an anachronism.

Section IX: the Rokeach's dates and city. The body: born "at the end of the seventeenth century"; fn 21: "c. 1665–1741". The body says Amsterdam's community was enormous "in the seventeenth and early eighteenth centuries"; fn 19 and fn 21 give 1735 and 1735–1740. The body says "both then living in Amsterdam" of the Yaavetz and the Rokeach, while the quoted responsum speaks of the rabbi of "my father's city" (the Yaavetz is usually placed in Altona). And "Such a thing had never happened in our history" is an unsourced superlative.

Voice. The body keeps the lecturer's first person ("I will not be מספיד today," "I do not know when ר׳ שלום last appeared in a משנה") and his dates ("the night of February 7") and his asides ("Try telling that to the ווינגעלייט"; "this caused a small commotion this morning"). Earlier reviews flagged the same; it is a decision for the edition, but it should be made consistently. Register is mixed ("yid," "yidden," "gabbai," "heilig" against "the attendant").

4.Factual / Citation Concerns

Fn 5. "Same author and work as referenced in earlier shiurim (file 50, fn 1; file 51, etc.)" is an internal working note and must go.

Fn 6 and the body. The body says the Gemara in *Berachos* teaches "whoever davens for his friend… is answered first"; fn 6 cites *Bava*

Kamma 92a and *Bereishis Rabbah* 52:5 and adds in brackets “the referenced שיעור זכות; the principal is בבא קמא A published note

cannot correct its own text; fix the body and drop the bracket. (The Midrash reference should be checked.)

Fn 7. The note cites *Berachos* 33b for “everything is in heaven’s hands except fear of heaven” but does not name the Sage; and the Maharsha’s resolution is rendered in the note as a request for “closeness,” which is not what the body says (“He has no choice”). The logic is missing in both: why would a request for fear of *Him* bind Him when other requests do not?

Fn 9. The note says the *Shulchan Aruch*’s opening *siman* “includes the recital of *Parshas HaMan* daily as a *segulah* for *parnassah*.” The *seif*

number (1:5) is in the short title; verify that this seif says that and does not merely list the passage among those it is good to say. (The *Beis Yosef* and *Tur* are said to bring a *Yerushalmi*; a specific citation would help.)

Fn 13–14. Fn 13 says *Hodu* is "recited universally" in *Nusach Sefard* shuls; the body says "almost every." Fn 14 says the *Maor Einayim* records the whole account of the journey and rescue; the body attributes to it only that the Besht instituted *Hodu*. Also the body lists the four categories as imprisoned, sea, ill, wilderness; fn 13 lists wilderness, prisoners, ill, seafarers. Same four, different orders; pick one.

Fn 15 and 16. Both give Hebrew "quotations" of the Gemara and Mishnah with ellipses; fn 16 quotes the Mishnah as "ובו ביום שניתן and

the body gives a different wording for the end of the same sentence

(“שלא כתבי הקודש קודש. One text should be used and checked against

the printed Mishnah.

Fn 19–22. A specific siman (*Sheilas Yaavetz* I:170), a specific museum

(“Jewish Historical Museum (Amsterdam)” for a coin the body says is in

“museums”), a specific Zohar folio (I, 62b) and “cf. *Tikkunei Zohar*.”

None of these is in the body, none is hedged. Fn 21 gives “buried in

Tzfat,” while the body does not say where.

Fn 23 and Section XI. The note says the Gemara in *Sanhedrin* 21b

“develops Shlomo’s violation of all three.” To my memory the sugya there

concerns wives and horses (“I will multiply and not turn away”); check

that gold is there. And the claim that each *lav* “in principle carries

malkus” deserves a source.

5.Small Polish Suggestions

- The heading “תשב״ץ קטן and the מהר״ם מרוטנבורג’s Personal ערבות” mixes scripts in a way the other headings do not; make them parallel.
- “The הייליגער בעל שם טוב”, “holy אלשיך”, “holy אור החיים”: pick an honorific convention and keep it.
- Headings X and XI use the number 117 in different forms (“The Calculation of the 117 פסוקים” and “The 117 of שלמה המלך’s Atonement”); the second reads oddly.
- “The גמרא in שבת” appears without a daf in the body; add it once.
- The dedication appears both as a *div* and again in the colophon; one is enough.
- The closing summary adds a new idea (“the world of יראה, the world of תשובה, the world of פרנסה”) that the body does not set up. Either build it or drop it.
- The Hebrew date is missing from the header (earlier editions carry it).

6.Bottom Line

> *A readable, well-ordered write-up with a very good second half. It needs one mechanical pass (the “Jerusalem minhag,” the Seder HaYom sentence, the Tashbetz acronym and the Agudah, the nested title in Section IX, the Rokeach’s dates), one clean-up of the apparatus (remove the “file 50” note and the bracketed correction in fn 6, harmonize the Mishnah quotations, hedge fn 9, 13, 14 and 19–23), and a decision about voice. With those done it can stand as a sefer chapter.*

Produced by an independent editorial pass reading the finished HTML only, without the transcripts. Reviewer brings the perspective of a learned general reader familiar with the standard *Gemara* and the Rambam’s *Mishneh Torah*.